PassFrame
TUITION

The Gloomwood Beast

Year 5 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

'Twas creepling dusk, and shadows thin
did flimmer through the Gloomwood trees;
the mossfrogs croaked a wurbling din,
and bramblecrows coughed on the breeze.

'Beware the Beast of Gloomwood deep,
my child,' the old woodcutter said,
'whose griplefangs will never sleep,
whose eyes burn ember-coal-ash-red.'

So Finn set out with blunted blade
to face the Beast in twilight air;
he crossed the Whistling Glen, unafraid,
though brindlewisps tugged at his hair.

The Beast arose with a thrundering roar,
all scalesmoke, claw, and creaking bone —
but Finn stood firm upon the floor
and would not face the dark alone.

One swift-struck blow, one blazing cry,
the Beast lay still beneath the moon.
Finn wiped his blade and gave a sigh,
then whistled home a gentle tune.

'Oh, bravest child!' the woodcutter beamed,
'you've slain the Beast that haunts our land!'
And through the Gloomwood, sunlight streamed,
for peace, once more, was close at hand.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. Who warns Finn about the Beast of Gloomwood?

2. What does Finn take with him to face the Beast?

3. Underline the line that tells you Finn was not afraid as he crossed the glen.

4. Underline 3 made-up (invented) words from the poem.

5. Using the clues in the poem, what do you think “griplefangs” means?

6. True or false: the Beast defeats Finn.

7. Why do you think the poet invented new words like “flimmer” and “thrundering” instead of using real ones?

8. What does the woodcutter call Finn at the end of the poem?

9. In your own words, describe what happens in the final battle between Finn and the Beast.

10. What does the phrase “sunlight streamed” at the end suggest about the mood of the poem's ending?

11. Why do you think the poet chose to end the poem with the woodcutter's praise rather than the fight itself?

12. If you had to invent one new nonsense word for this poem, what would it be and what would it mean?